



Mouse Stroke in action

version. There's a reason why there are only a few gesture extensions that work on Linux and Mac—or are there enough? I'm hoping this can be solved soon but, well, I don't know when.

I'm currently working on user-defined strokes. Most gesture extensions on Firefox have this feature. The idea is to let users create their own gesture handling scripts. Hopefully, it will be available on Mouse Stroke soon.

[Update: Mouse Stroke now works on Linux and Mac, and the feature for user-defined strokes is also available.]

Q Do you work on software for a living? Would you call yourself a developer or a Web designer?

I'm a developer. My work is to develop software to process financial data. I was interested in Web development back in college, mainly using PHP. I wrote my own forum software for my WoW guild, a website for my lab. I also developed a website for someone in Boston years ago. But I don't think I'm a Web developer. Most of my programs are written in C++, PL/SQL, and recently Perl. However, Web development is fun—I'm spending more and more time on it.

Q Chrome extensions are only JS, HTML, and CSS + images, right? And it sounds like you are more of a traditional application developer. So is it easy to work on an extension instead of using C++ or Perl?

Chrome extensions are JS, HTML and CSS, but it's not regular JS that's used on websites. Google implemented some APIs to expose the internals of Chrome, so extensions can do things like add bookmarks, move tabs



Mouse Stroke options

around, etc. However, this API set is still minimal—there's still a lot of work to be done to make Chrome's extension system as powerful as Firefox's.

Developing browser extensions (or Web applications) is easier than developing traditional applications, because recent browsers are all packed with great developer tools. All you need is a browser and a text editor. But for traditional languages, you have to know the compiler, the linker and the debugger. You have to know different runtime environments. There are so many things to take care of.

Besides, Web/extension development is more fun and more addictive. We rely on Web applications so much these days and a simple browser extension could help you immensely. Also, users can get access to your applications in a much easier way. 

References

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By: Anthony Bryan

The author loves the arts and technology, and is trying to improve downloads with the Metlink project.

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